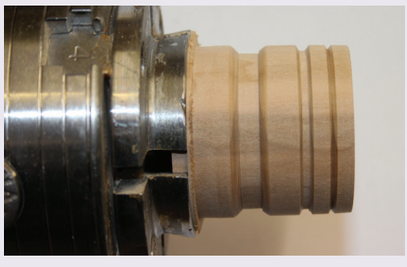
1. HOW TO FIT A LID

My lids are fitted so that if you lift the box by the lid the bottom part will hold for a few seconds before it drops off. I plan the job so I cut the recess first; this needs to be parallel to make fitting the lid easier, be careful when sanding not to round over the front edge. When it comes to turning the spigot, I only turn a 2mm step wide on the front edge when the fit is close and I regularly stop the lathe to test the fit. Take very small cuts, don't take too much off at once or the fit will be slack. Once it fits on the small step, I turn the full width. If I make a mistake when turning the small step I only waste 2mm not the full width. Again, sand carefully with a fine grade or the fit will be loose.

2. JOINTS ON BOXES

This sounds so simple and it can be by following a few simple rules when fitting a lid. The most common question is what sort of fit, tight or loose. It the fit is so tight that it is hard to separate the top and bottom, it will be impractical for everyday use. I tend to place the spigot on the bottom part and the recess on the lid, because if this is used and you place contents in the bottom part that has the recess, small items could become broken when the spigot slides into the recess. This is my preference. The grain on the joint line rarely lines up due to the timber that has been used for the joint and parting cut. I chamfer both edges so the mismatch grain is not so noticeable. This is a three-joint design that can be used on boxes.



PLANS AND EQUIPMENT

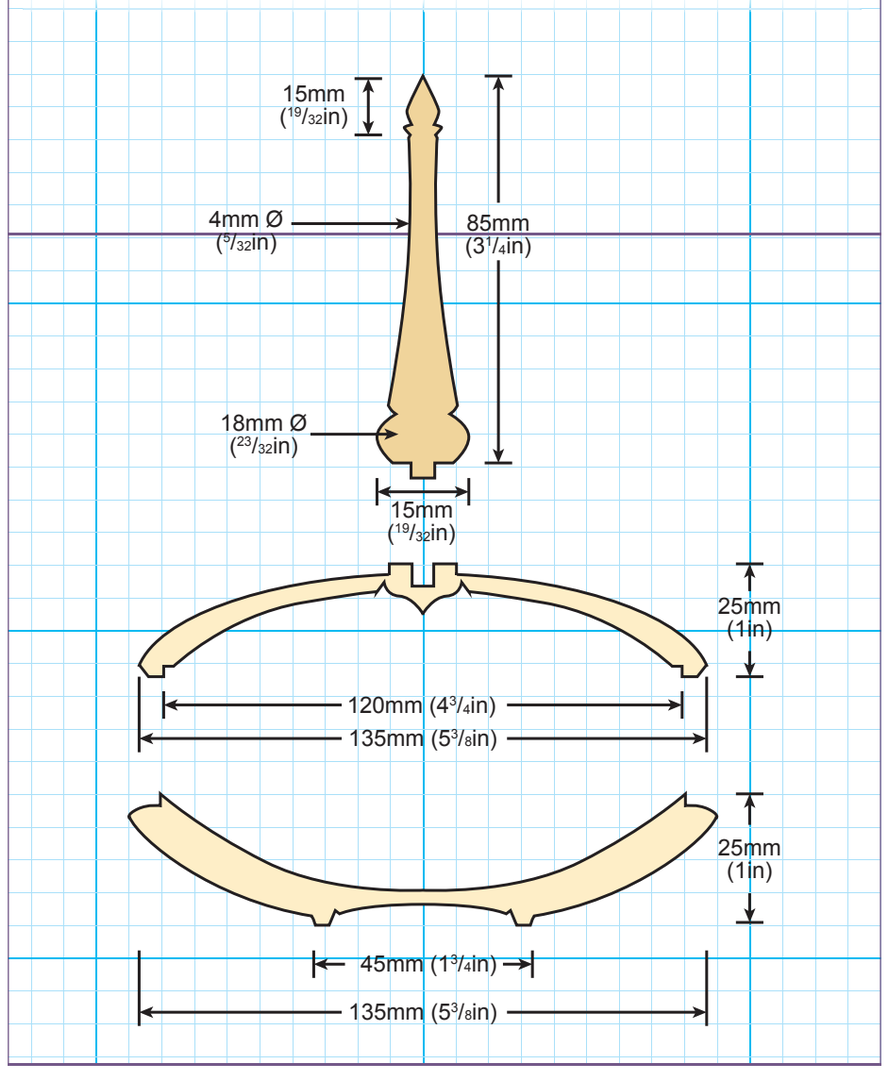
EQUIPMENT USED

Tools required

10mm bowl gouge
25mm French curve scraper
3mm parting tool
20mm skew
10mm spindle gouge with a fingernail profile

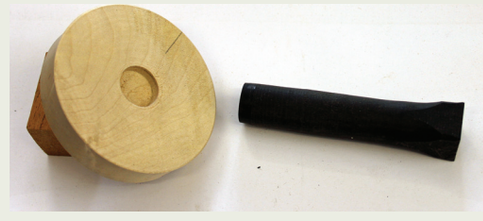
Timber requirements

Beech (*Fagus sylvatica*) for box 140 x 60mm
Blackwood (*Dalbergia melanoxylon*) for finial 110 x 20mm sq



3. HOLDING SMALL PARTS

How do I hold small pieces of timber when I need to finish the end at the tailstock end without tailstock support? Well I have several sizes of chuck jaws so this is not a problem now, but what if you only have the original set that came with the chuck? Let's say the timber is only 20mm in diameter, I will turn a spigot on one end around 20mm long, and makw the diameter the maximum that I can achieve. Then place a piece of scrap timber in the chuck then drill or turn a hole in this to the diameter of the spigot on the small piece of timber. Now glue this in to the hole and let the glue set, then you can turn the small piece without tailstock support.



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